

National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey

August 2021-August 2023 Data Documentation, Codebook, and Frequencies

Pesticide Use (PUQMEC_L)

Data File: PUQMEC_L.xpt

First Published: September 2024

Last Revised: NA

Component Description

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The pesticide use questionnaire (variable name prefix PUQ) provides data on pesticide use during the past seven days in the home, and on the lawn or in the garden.

Pesticides are substances or a mixture of substances intended for preventing, destroying, repelling, or mitigating any pest (EPA, 2020). Many common household products that are used inside and outside of the home are considered pesticides, thus increasing the risk of exposure to these substances. The PUQ seeks to obtain meaningful data about potential exposure to chemicals in and around the household among NHANES participants.

Eligible Sample

All participants aged 6 years and older, in the NHANES August 2021 – August 2023 sample, were eligible.

Interview Setting and Mode of Administration

The PUQ was asked in the mobile examination center (MEC) by phlebotomists or trained interviewers using the Computer-Assisted Personal Interview (CAPI) system.

Participants 18 years of age and older were interviewed directly. A proxy provided information for participants 6-17 years of age.

Quality Assurance & Quality Control

The CAPI system is programmed with built-in consistency checks to reduce data entry errors. CAPI also uses online help screens to assist interviewers in defining key terms used in the questionnaire. During the August 2021-August 2023 data collection cycle, PUQ data were systematically reviewed for logical, processing, and data input errors on a periodic basis; and interviewer-specific feedback and retraining was performed as appropriate.

Data Processing and Editing

Data were edited for completeness and consistency.

Analytic Notes

Please refer to the [NHANES Analytic Guidelines](#) and the on-line [NHANES Tutorial](#) for further details on the use of sample weights and other analytic issues.

References

- "About Pesticides." EPA. Environmental Protection Agency, April 14, 2020.
<https://www.epa.gov/pesticides>

Codebook and Frequencies

SEQN - Respondent sequence number

Variable Name:	SEQN
SAS Label:	Respondent sequence number
English Text:	Respondent sequence number.
Target:	Both males and females 6 YEARS - 150 YEARS

PUQ100 - Products used in home to control insects

Variable Name: PUQ100

SAS Label: Products used in home to control insects

English Text: In the past 7 days, were any chemical products used in {your/his/her} home to control fleas, roaches, ants, termites, or other insects?

English Instructions: CAPI INSTRUCTION: IF SP 6-17 YEARS, DISPLAY THE FOLLOWING
INTERVIEWER INSTRUCTION: "THIS ITEM IS COLLECTED VIA PROXY FOR SPS 6-17. LOOK UP THE PROXY RESPONSE IN THE PUQ REPORT AND ENTER IT IN PUQ100"

Target: Both males and females 6 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	569	569	
2	No	7434	8003	
7	Refused	0	8003	
9	Don't know	28	8031	
.	Missing	37	8068	

PUQ110 - Products used to kill weeds?

Variable Name: PUQ110

SAS Label: Products used to kill weeds?

English Text: In the past 7 days, were any chemical products used in {your/his/her} lawn or garden to kill weeds?

English Instructions: CODE "NO" IF THE RESPONDENT SAYS S/HE DOES NOT HAVE A LAWN OR GARDEN. CAPI INSTRUCTION: IF SP 6-17 YEARS, DISPLAY THE FOLLOWING INTERVIEWER INSTRUCTION: "THIS ITEM IS COLLECTED VIA PROXY FOR SPS 6-17. LOOK UP THE PROXY RESPONSE IN THE PUQ REPORT AND ENTER IT IN PUQ110."

Target: Both males and females 6 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	364	364	
2	No	7589	7953	
7	Refused	0	7953	
9	Don't know	78	8031	
.	Missing	37	8068	